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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

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General Comment

The unregulated scraping of works of art to train AI systems raises significant ethical and moral concerns, particularly regarding the rights and livelihoods of the artists who created these works. Artists pour their time, creativity, and passion into their creations, often relying on their work for income and professional recognition. When their art is scraped without consent or compensation, it undermines their autonomy and devalues their labor. This practice essentially treats their work as a free resource for corporate profit, disregarding the fact that these creations are the intellectual property of individuals who deserve to have a say in how their work is used.

You should also think about this: the lack of regulation in this area creates a power imbalance between artists and large tech companies. Many artists, especially independent or emerging ones, lack the resources or legal support to challenge the unauthorized use of their work. This exploitation perpetuates a system where corporations benefit from the creative labor of individuals without contributing to the sustainability of the artistic community. By failing to establish clear guidelines or compensation mechanisms, we risk eroding trust in the relationship between technology and the arts, potentially stifling creativity and discouraging artists from sharing their work publicly.

This unregulated use of art to train AI systems you're aiming for also raises broader questions about the ethical development of technology. AI has the potential to revolutionize many fields, but its progress should not come at the expense of fairness and respect for human creativity. If the foundation of AI is built on the uncompensated labor of artists, it sets a troubling precedent for how we value human contributions in the digital age. Regulating the use of artistic works in AI training is not just about protecting individual rights—it's about ensuring that technological advancement aligns with principles of equity and respect for all forms of human expression.